

AI Mode All Images Videos Shopping Forums Short videos More ▾ Tools ▾

## ◆ AI Overview

Depending on your goal, you can mean **two entirely different things** when talking about **rclone encrypt from cli**:

1. **Encrypting your files/folders** before uploading them to the cloud (creating a `crypt` remote).  RcloneView
2. **Encrypting your `rclone.conf` configuration file** to protect your API keys and tokens.  Rclone

## 1. Encrypting Files and Folders (Crypt Remote)

Rclone uses a special virtual wrapper remote called `crypt` to encrypt files locally before uploading them.  Rclone +1

### Scripted / Non-Interactive CLI Creation

To completely bypass the interactive menu, you can pass all configuration parameters directly using the [rclone config create](#) command. You must first use `rclone obscure` to hash your password so rclone can read it securely in cleartext within the command.  rclone forum +1

#### bash

```
# 1. Generate obscured versions of your chosen password and optional salt
OBSCURED_PASS=$(rclone obscure "YourSuperStrongPassword")
OBSCURED_SALT=$(rclone obscure "YourOptionalSaltPassword")
```

```
# 2. Build the encrypted remote via CLI
# Replace 'mys3remote:mybucket' with your existing destination path
rclone config create my-secure-crypt crypt \
    remote "mys3remote:mybucket/encrypted-folder" \
    password "$OBSCURED_PASS" \
    password2 "$OBSCURED_SALT" \
```

Use code with caution.



(Note: If you do not wish to use a salt, omit the `password2` line entirely.) Reddit +1

## Using Environment Variables

Alternatively, you can dynamically spin up an encrypted remote using environment variables on the fly without changing your configuration file at all: rclone forum +1

**bash**

```
export RCLONE_CONFIG_MYSECRET_TYPE=crypt
export RCLONE_CONFIG_MYSECRET_REMOTE="mys3remote:mybucket/encrypted-folder
export RCLONE_CONFIG_MYSECRET_PASSWORD=$(rclone obscure "YourSuperStrongPa

# Now you can instantly use it
rclone copy /path/to/local/files mysecret:
```

Use code with caution.



## 2. Encrypting the Rclone Configuration File

If you want to protect your `rclone.conf` tokens against local threat actors, you can encrypt the configuration file itself using standard global tools. Reddit · r/rclone +1

### Encrypting the Configuration File

Run the explicit config encryption command: Rclone

**bash**

```
rclone config encryption set
```

Use code with caution.



The CLI will ask you to set a password. Once set, nobody can read your `rclone.conf` profile without providing that master key. rclone forum +1



Once your `rclone.conf` is password-protected, every subsequent rclone execution will halt to request the password. To automate this in headless environments or scripts, pass the password via an environment variable:  rclone forum +2

**bash**

```
export RCLONE_CONFIG_PASS="your-master-config-password"
```

```
# Rclone will now run without prompting you for the password  
rclone sync /local/dir my-secure-crypt:
```

Use code with caution.



+ Ask anything



```
rclone config encryption remove
```

Use code with caution.



Are you attempting to build an **automated backup script**, or are you setting up a **new storage backend** for personal use? Let me know if you need help generating the exact script layout!





rclone forum

<https://forum.rclone.org> › encrypting-config-file-throu...

## Encrypting config file through command line

Sep 18, 2023 — Have a look at this approach: Possible to set a password for the **rclone** config file without using **rclone** config (2)? Feature. [Read more](#)



Rclone

<https://rclone.org> › commands › rclone\_config\_encryption

## rclone config encryption

This command **sets, clears and checks the encryption for the config file** using the subcommands below.

Options. -h, --help help for encryption. See the global ... [Read more](#)

Missing: ~~en~~ | Show results with: **cli**



rclone forum

<https://forum.rclone.org> › how-to-create-new-crypt-rem...

## How to create new "crypt" remote from command line

May 22, 2020 — hi all, I'd like to add a new "crypt" remote based on another one of my remotes. I can **easily do that through the interactive rclone config** ...



Rclone

<https://rclone.org> › crypt

## Crypt

Aug 27, 2026 — When working against the crypt remote, **rclone will automatically encrypt** (before uploading) and decrypt (after downloading) on your local system ... [Read more](#)



rclone forum

<https://forum.rclone.org> › encrypted-sync-from-comma...

## Encrypted sync from commandline - Help and Support

Sep 30, 2023 — What is the problem you are having with **rclone**? I have trouble finding the right combination of commands and flags to perform the following ...





Rclone

<https://rclone.org> › commands

## Rclone Commands

**rclone config encryption**, set, remove and check the encryption for the config file. rclone config encryption check, Check that the config file is encrypted. [Read more](#)



GitHub

<https://github.com> › rclone › rclone › issues

## Configuration Encryption via Command Line or Script #3241

May 30, 2019 — To encrypt: **rclone config encrypt "mypassword"** or without the "mypassword" and directly retrieve RCLONE\_CONFIG\_PASS. To decrypt: rclone config ... [Read more](#)



Reddit · r/rclone

10+ comments · 1 year ago

## Best Way to Secure rclone.conf from Local Access?

**You can indeed encrypt the config.** You can use a password command to decrypt it. What OS are you using (Windows/Linux/Mac)? [Read more](#)

How to create new "crypt" remote from command line - Help and Support - rclone forum



rclone forum

You can use the following command to store passwords in cleartext: \* `rclone config create

CRYPT crypt \remote \$REMOTE \n  
<https://forum.rclone.org/how-should-i-mass-encrypt-...>

## How should I mass-encrypt my crypt? - Help and Support

rclone forum

Dec 10, 2022 — The **command** you were trying to run (eg **rclone copy /tmp remote:tmp** ). Did not run any

**Encrypted sync from commandline - rclone forum**  
**command to mass-encrypt my files. Came here to ask ...** [Read more](#)

ELSE ( echo Directory RCLONEBACK does not exist, creating mkdir

Missing: cd | Show results with cli  
%CURRENT\_DRIVE%\RCLONEBACK ) :: clear if any set RCLONE\_CONFIG\_%RC...

## People also search for



Rclone

How to use rclone encrypt from cli



and

Rclone copy

Rclone encrypt from cli **github**Rclone **crypt**Rclone **config encryption**

N E

Rclone **sync**Rclone encrypt **local folder**Rclone **config password**

Results are not personalized

**Keystone at the Crossing, Indianapolis, IN** - [Based on your places \(Home\)](#) - [Update location](#)

[Help](#)   [Send feedback](#)   [Privacy](#)   [Terms](#)